

Comment Catalog Template

One row per comment, and the options still open

1 What the catalog is for

Question 68 gives the shape. After the comments have been labeled and cataloged, a table whose first cell is the comment, carrying a link that jumps to one or more complete excerpts, then several columns of characterization, then one cell chosen from a list rather than written, then a few ways of answering that comment or that group of comments.

The catalog sits between reading the reviews and drafting the response, and it does the one thing a draft cannot. It holds every comment open at the same time. A response written straight from the reviews settles the first comment before the last one has been read, and the answer that reads well inside a paragraph is not always the answer that survives the whole set. So the catalog fixes the order of the work: characterize everything, list the ways of answering, choose last.

It is working apparatus. None of it reaches the response form.

2 The columns

Eight, in this order. Three of them carry the characterization, one is the selected cell, and the last two are the part the author decides.

Column	What it holds	Values
Comment	The identifier, then the comment in one line. Use the reviewer's own words where one sentence carries the whole complaint, and a compression that keeps their nouns where it does not. The identifier is the link.	The identifier, then free text
Excerpts	Where the complete text lives. The response cluster that answers it, and every manuscript passage the comment is about, by file and line.	Free text, locators only
Disputes	What the comment challenges.	Fixed list
Stance	What we do with it.	Fixed list
Root	The other identifiers that would be answered by the same change. Empty when the comment travels alone.	Identifiers
Cost	What answering it would take. This is the selected cell.	Fixed list
Options	Two or more ways of answering, most preferred first, one line each.	Numbered free text
Decision	The option chosen, or the word open and the name of what settles it.	Free text

Why Root is a column and not a grouping. Grouping the rows by cluster hides the comments that belong to two clusters at once, and those are the expensive ones. Keep one row per comment,

in reviewer order, and let the Root cell carry the grouping. The response clusters are then read off the column instead of being imposed on the table.

3 The three fixed lists

Disputes. What the comment challenges, in the vocabulary of claims and attacks. A challenge to the CLAIM disputes what the paper asserts. A challenge to the EVIDENCE accepts the claim as meaningful and disputes what supports it. A challenge to the WARRANT accepts both and disputes the step between them. A challenge to a DEFINITION disputes what a term picks out. A challenge to SIGNIFICANCE disputes whether the result matters. PRESENTATION is the sixth value and covers everything that disputes neither the argument nor the result. A strength gets the value NONE here and in the two columns after it, and it gets a row, because a strength is a thing the response can lose.

Stance. REFUTE, the comment rests on a misreading. CONCEDE, the comment finds a real defect. NARROW, the evidence supports something smaller than the paper claims and the claim moves. REFRAME, the fact is not in dispute and its presentation is. DEFER, real and outside this window. Two values in one cell are allowed and are common: a comment that bundles a factual reading with an inference drawn from it is refuted on the reading and reframed on the inference, and writing both into the cell is what keeps the two halves from being answered as one.

Cost. WORDS ONLY, answerable from what is already written. EXISTING DATA, answerable from runs already performed, including reporting them differently. ONE RUN, one configuration under the protocol already used. FOLLOW-UP PROJECT, work at a scale that a revision window does not hold.

4 The one selected cell

Cost is the cell chosen from a list rather than written, and it sits between the characterization and the options because it decides which options are admissible before any of them is drafted.

The rule it enforces is short. A row whose cost is WORDS ONLY or EXISTING DATA takes a commitment. A row whose cost is ONE RUN takes a commitment only with the author's signature on it. A row whose cost is FOLLOW-UP PROJECT never takes a commitment, because promising work at that scale says the paper is a major revision at best, and the venue's own categories then apply that reading rather than ours.

Filling this cell honestly is the whole value of the column. The temptation is to write WORDS ONLY for a comment that a paragraph could deflect, and the check against it is the excerpt column: if no passage in the manuscript already contains the answer, the cost is not words.

5 The options column

Two or more, most preferred first, each one line, each naming what it does and what it costs. The last option is always the one that answers without new work, so the row can be closed under time pressure without being reopened.

Several options are required when the comment is a question asking for work. Question 68 gives the reason: comments arrive in the form “could the authors evaluate attackers that differ

in other behaviors,” and a single option turns that question into a commitment before the author has seen the choice. Three options are usually available for such a comment, and they are worth writing out even when the first is obviously right. Answer the question as asked, from what exists. Offer the work, numbered, with what it would show. Commit to the work outright.

An option is not a preference until it says what it buys and what it gives up. One line for each is enough, and the line goes in the option, not in the decision. The decision cell records the choice. It does not re-argue it.

The option nobody writes down is the one worth adding. A comment answered by a correction rather than by a run appears only if someone checks whether the run in question was already performed under a different label. Put that check in the excerpt column and the option writes itself.

6 The link

The first cell links to the full excerpt so that the table can be read without the reviews open beside it. In a compiled document the mechanism is a target and a link, one target per comment, placed in the excerpt box.

The target goes once, where the reviewer’s complete sentences are quoted. The identifier in the catalog carries the link. Both stay stable across drafts, which matters because the identifiers themselves are an editorial invention and appear nowhere in the reviews.

7 The macros

% One catalog row. Eight cells, in the column order above.

```
\newcommand{\ccrow}[8]{%
```

```
\ccid{#1} & #2 & #3 & #4 & #5 & \cccost{#6} & #7 & #8 \\}
```

% The link. \cctarget{A4} goes once, in the excerpt box that quotes A4

% in full. \ccid{A4} renders the linked identifier in the catalog.

```
\newcommand{\cctarget}[1]{\hypertarget{cc#1}{}}
```

```
\newcommand{\ccid}[1]{\hyperlink{cc#1}{\textbf{#1}}}
```

% The selected cell. One of: words only, existing data, one run,

% follow-up project. Anything outside the list is a value the list

% does not have, and the list is what makes the column sortable.

```
\newcommand{\cccost}[1]{\scshape #1}
```

% One option. #1 its number, #2 what it does and what it costs.

```
\newcommand{\ccopt}[2]{\textbf{#1.}\ #2}
```

% A decision that has not been made. #1 what settles it.

```
\newcommand{\ccopen}[1]{\itshape Open.}\ #1}
```

8 The skeleton, one row

```
\ccrow{[identifier]}
{[the comment in one line, their nouns kept]}
{[response cluster; manuscript file and line, one per passage]}
{[claim / evidence / warrant / definition / significance / presentation]}
{[refute / concede / narrow / reframe / defer]}
{[identifiers sharing the root, or empty]}
{[words only / existing data / one run / follow-up project]}
{\ccopt{1}{[what it does, what it costs]} \ccopt{2}{[the fallback that needs no new
work]}}
{[the option chosen, or \ccopen{[what settles it]}]}
```

The table itself is a `longtable` on a sideways page, set by widening the geometry around the table alone and restoring it afterward, so the prose sections keep a readable measure. Eight columns do not fit upright at a size anyone would read, and shrinking the options column until they do defeats the column.

9 Filling it

Six steps, and only the last two are decisions.

1. Extract every comment from the reviews verbatim, including the strengths. Assign each an identifier, reviewer letter and running number, and never renumber.
2. Quote each one in full in an excerpt box and put the target there. One box per comment, in the reviewers' own order.
3. Find every manuscript passage the comment is about and record file and line. This step, not the reading of the review, is where a misreading gets caught.
4. Fill the three characterization columns for all comments before writing a single option. A stance chosen while the next comment is still unread is a stance chosen twice.
5. Write the options. Most preferred first, the no-new-work answer last.
6. Take the decisions, or write what each one waits on. Rows waiting on a verification name the file or the log that would settle them. Rows waiting on the author name nothing else.

10 The spreadsheet version

Question 69 asks for it, and the reason it exists is sharing: a coauthor sorts by cost and reads only the rows that need a signature.

One header row, one row per comment, the same eight columns and the same order. The three fixed lists become validation lists on their columns, which is what makes the selected cell a selection rather than a phrase somebody typed twice two different ways.

Two cells travel badly and both have the same fix. The options cell holds the option labels only, numbered, one per line inside the cell, and the full text of each option stays in the document. The

excerpt cell holds the locators without their links, since a link into a compiled document does not survive the export. Everything else transfers one cell to one cell.

Generate the delimited rows from the same source as the table rather than keeping a second copy by hand. A second copy drifts, and the drift is found by whoever trusted the shared file.

11 What the catalog is not

It is not the response, and it is not a stage of the response. The response carries no identifiers, no stance labels, no cost classes, and no options, since options shown to a reviewer read as an invitation to pick the expensive one.

It is also not a record of what was decided after the fact. A catalog written once the response is drafted is a summary of the draft, and it can only agree with it. The value is in the interval where the options are still open, and that interval closes early.

12 Sources

- The column list, the link requirement, the selected cell, and the rule that several options are needed for a comment asking for work are all question 68, in the author's own statement of it.
- The spreadsheet version and its purpose are question 69.
- The claim, evidence, warrant, definition, and significance vocabulary is The Craft of Research, applied to reviewer comments in this package's analysis file and kept in the same senses here.
- The stance list and the root-cause grouping are the author's, already in use in the same file and in the response procedure on the website.
- The cost list is cut at the venue's own boundaries: what a revision window holds, and what it does not.